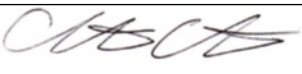


**Guideline Title: Capillary Blood Glucose Monitoring**

**Guideline Number: GUID-3203-PR003**

|                                                                                              |                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Issue date: 09/09/2014                                                                       | Replaces Dept. Policy:      |
| Revision dates: 4/30/24                                                                      | Developed by: Air Care Team |
| Approved by: Dr. Christopher Hunter, MD<br>Air Care Team Medical Director                    | Approved by:                |
| Signature:  | Signature:                  |
| Department Numbers: 3203                                                                     |                             |

- I. **PURPOSE:** To obtain capillary or venous blood sample and measure a blood glucose level.
- II. **DEFINITIONS:**
- III. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
  - a. **EQUIPMENT:**
    - i. Appropriately calibrated blood glucose testing device. Onboard is currently the *POCT Nova StatStrip Xpress2 Glucose Hospital Meter*. See Orlando Health Policy #3888 for testing guidelines using this device.
    - ii. Test strip, lancet, alcohol prep pad
  - b. **INDICATIONS:**
    - i. Known patient with history of diabetes experiencing an acute medical emergency
    - ii. Altered mental status, suspected stroke, or confirmed interfacility stroke transfer
    - iii. Suspected overdose, poisoning, or toxic exposure
    - iv. Unresponsiveness
    - v. Any neonate or pediatric patient prior to transport
    - vi. Any trauma patient
    - vii. Acute seizure
    - viii. Patients receiving a continuous insulin drip
  - c. **CONTRAINDICATIONS:** Testing results may not be accurate if hematocrits are < 20 g/dL or > 70 g/dL
  - d. **PROCEDURE:**
    - i. Select and prepare appropriate site with alcohol prep pad
      1. Pad of the finger in the adult or pediatric patient
      2. Heel of the neonate
      3. Obtain blood from venous access site if patient has decreased peripheral blood flow such as in acute shock, hypotension, or on multiple vasopressors. Neonate whole blood is not allowed.
    - ii. Insert test strip in blood glucose testing device, while allowing prepared site to dry.

**Guideline Title: Capillary Blood Glucose Monitoring**

**Guideline Number: GUID-3203-PR003**

- iii. Puncture prepared site with lancet and allow a large drop of blood to form.
- iv. Apply test strip to blood droplet and allow device to calculate the reading.
- v. Control bleeding and bandage puncture site.
- vi. If glucose level < 60 mg/dL, & symptomatic, treat per *GUID3203-M021 Hypoglycemia*.

**IV. DOCUMENTATION:**

- a. Record blood glucose in EMS Charts

**V. REFERENCES:**